SCAD
The University for Creative Careers

AI 101 Survey of AI Applications

Section: 01 CRN: 12976

SATLAB 123

Tuesday / Thursday 5:00 PM - 7:30 PM

SCAD mission

SCAD prepares talented students for creative professions through engaged teaching and learning in a positively oriented university environment.

SCAD vision

SCAD will be globally recognized as the preeminent source of knowledge in the disciplines we teach.

SCAD values

Be Strategic. Research and measure to guide work and document results.

Be Innovative. Generate new ideas and relevant solutions.

Be Positive. Approach all endeavors with enthusiasm.

Be Collaborative. Embrace and act upon our collective genius.

Be Transformative. Create life-changing experiences.

Be Compassionate. Treat everyone with kindness and care.

Instructor Information



Professor: Nathan Madrid
Email: nmadrid@scad.edu
Phone: 912.525.5312

Office Location
Monty
Office Hours: TBD, Zoom: https://scad.zoom.us/j/8382024752

Course Description

From generative media to intelligent environments, students discover the expanding role of AI across industries and creative disciplines. Students analyze real-world examples and trends to build a broad, cross-sector understanding of what AI can do and imagine what comes next. Prerequisite(s): None.

Student Learning Outcomes

1. Students analyze and document the effectiveness of prompt engineering iterations and refinements AI platforms to achieve specific creative goals.
2. Students produce original multimodal artworks utilizing multiple AI tools and traditional creative methodologies..
3. Students articulate ethical frameworks for AI use in creative practice.

Class Meeting Dates

1. Tuesday, September 15, 2026
2. Thursday, September 17, 2026
3. Tuesday, September 22, 2026
4. Thursday, September 24, 2026
5. Tuesday, September 29, 2026
6. Thursday, October 1, 2026
7. Tuesday, October 6, 2026
8. Thursday, October 8, 2026
9. Tuesday, October 13, 2026
10. Thursday, October 15, 2026
11. Tuesday, October 20, 2026
12. Thursday, October 22, 2026
13. Tuesday, October 27, 2026
14. Thursday, October 29, 2026
15. Tuesday, November 3, 2026
16. Thursday, November 5, 2026
17. Tuesday, November 10, 2026
18. Thursday, November 12, 2026

19. Tuesday, November 17, 2026
20. Thursday, November 19, 2026

Pre-quarter Assignment

Description

Your Agent Brief

The Idea

Before we make anything, we need to know what you want to build and why. The course ends with you building a personal AI agent you can carry into your other classes: a folder with an instruction file and a verified source set that works for you. That agent starts here. This brief defines the job before the tool.

The Assignment

Write a short brief about who you are as a creative person, what you want AI to help you do, and what you already know about how AI shows up in your field. You are not building anything yet. You are defining the work an agent will eventually help you do, and what it should never do for you.

Guiding Questions (use as starting points, not a checklist):

- • You and Your Field: What is your major or creative focus? What kind of work do you want to make?
- • The Job for Your Agent: What is one thing you would want a personal AI assistant to help you with in your other classes or your practice? What should it never do for you?
- • What You Already Know: What have you seen AI do in your field? What are you curious about? What do you doubt?
- • What You Bring: What do you already do well as a creator that AI should not replace?

The Output

A one-page brief, roughly 400 to 600 words, as plain text or a designed document. Structure it with the four headings above. Written or designed, your choice. Show me how you communicate.

Why This Matters

This brief becomes the seed of Project 3's field study and the intent of your capstone agent. The capstone asks for an intent statement written in your own words before AI shapes it. This is that statement, written early and honestly. Know what you want, then point the tool at it.

Due Date: By the first class meeting.

Description
No AI use is expected or required for this assignment. It is your thinking on paper, before any tool.

Schedule of Classes

Class	Date	Meeting Information
1	9/14/26	UNIT 1: FOUNDATIONS (Classes 1-4) Class 1: Set Up Your Practice Course overview and expectations The inference loop: prompt to inference to output Your workspace: Markdown, local vs cloud, a project folder Start your AI Use Log
2	9/16/26	Class 2: Make Something First creative artifact with one AI tool The keep-or-reject rhythm What surprised you
3	9/21/26	Class 3: See the Whole Room Class comparison of first artifacts The Tool, Agent, and System framework Where the work converged and where it held its own
4	9/23/26	Class 4: Name the Trade What the comparison reveals about individual pieces and the group Cognitive offloading: what you hand to the tool and what comes back Publish your folder to GitHub
5	9/28/26	UNIT 2: THE DESIGN PROCESS (Classes 5-8) Class 5: Name the Process The design process: intent, research, prototype, feedback, iterate Trace your first artifact through the cycle Write an intent before building

Class	Date	Meeting Information
6	9/30/26	Class 6: Verify Your Sources Set up a research helper Gather real, named sources for your work Check AI claims against them
7	10/5/26	Class 7: Build a Pipeline Combine 2 to 3 tools into one directed workflow, across at least two media types The intent gap: what you asked for vs. what you got Ideate first, then build
8	10/7/26	Class 8: Take Feedback, Iterate AI as critique partner, plus peer crit One revision that keeps some output and overrides other parts
9	10/12/26	UNIT 3: YOUR FIELD (Classes 9-12) Class 9: Disclosure and Position The Disclosure Protocol A short ethical position: authorship, bias, consent Real cases of AI in creative fields
10	10/14/26	Class 10: Study Your Field Add disclosure to a prior artifact How AI shows up in your discipline Gather sources for a field study
11	10/19/26	Class 11: Build for Your Field A larger pipeline in your chosen field, combining at least two media types Ground it in a real case or your own research
12	10/21/26	Class 12: Crit and Revise Bring the build in front of the room before it is done One revision from feedback

Class	Date	Meeting Information
13	10/26/26	UNIT 4: ORCHESTRATION (Classes 13-20) Class 13: Define Your Agent Orchestration: directing tools and context toward one purpose An intent for a personal agent: what job, for whom, what it must not do
14	10/28/26	Class 14: Assemble the Sources Build a verified source set Extend your field study into the agent's context
15	11/2/26	Class 15: Build and Test Write the instruction file and load the sources First test of the agent
16	11/4/26	Class 16: Find the Failures Use the agent on real work Where it fails and why Studio time and group check-in
17	11/9/26	Class 17: Revise Fix the instructions, correct or expand the sources Re-test on the same task
18	11/11/26	Class 18: Confirm the Difference Compare the two cycles Your AI Use Log as the decision history
19	11/16/26	Class 19: Demo and Defend Live demo Explain the context decisions Defend the limits: what it gets wrong and how you know
20	11/18/26	Class 20: Reflect and Carry Forward What AI did, what you kept as your own What you carry into your other courses

Grading Opportunities

#	Due Date	Assignment	Weight
1	9/23/26	Project 1: Make, Then Compare	15%
2	10/7/26	Project 2: Small Orchestration	20%
3	10/21/26	Project 3: Your Field, With AI	20%
4	11/18/26	Capstone: Your Own Agent	30%
5	11/18/26	Professional Practice	15

Grading Standards

Letter Grade	Quality	Range	Undergraduate Quality Points	Graduate Quality Points
A	Excellent	90 - 100%	4	4
B	Good	80 - 89%	3	3
C	Satisfactory	70 - 79%	2	2
D	Poor	60 - 69%	1	0
F	Failing	0 - 59%	0	0

Required Materials

Laptop computer. Students also need a free GitHub account (set up in class, Week 2) and access to free-tier AI tools. No software purchases required.

SCAD Bookstore

The SCAD bookstore carries textbooks, art supplies, and other materials to meet students' academic needs. Please visit the website linked below and search for this course to view costs of associated texts and materials.

Savannah – Ex Libris

228 Martin Luther King Jr. Blvd

Phone: 912.525.7550

https://www.bkstr.com/savannahstore/home

Atlanta – Ex Libris

1470 Spring St, SW

Phone: 404.253.6088

https://www.bkstr.com/scadatlantastore/home

SCADnow

https://www.bkstr.com/savannahstore/home

Study (Field) Trips

Study Trip	Date	Description
1		TBD and will announce on BB

Extra Help Sessions

Extra Help Sessions	Date	Description
1		Extra Help Session are on Fridays, Date and Time will be announced on BB
2		Extra Help Session are on Fridays, Date and Time will be announced on BB
4		Extra Help Session are on Fridays, Date and Time will be announced on BB
3		Extra Help Session are on Fridays, Date and Time will be announced on BB

Extended Learning Opportunities

Extended learning opportunities are designed to enrich and expand students' course-based learning experiences. These university-wide extended learning opportunities (i.e., SCADamp workshops, SCADextra workshops, events and exhibitions, guided studio work, and virtual engagements) are offered both on-ground and virtually and allow students to further explore their discipline, discover new information, and deepen academic engagement.

Use the links below to view the schedule of upcoming events.

https://myevents.scad.edu/

https://app.scad.edu/workshops/

Information regarding extended learning opportunities specific to this course may also be communicated via Blackboard.

Suggested Extended Learning Opportunities
Suggested ELO's are posted on BB, and subject to change.

SCAD Libraries and Academic Resources

SCAD Libraries
Students at all SCAD locations can access SCAD Libraries' extensive collections, digital resources, and research assistance both in person and online. Explore SCAD Libraries here: Millennium Web Catalog (scad.edu).

SCADextra Coaching: Academic Resources
SCADextra Coaching is your primary source for academic resources and support for students at all SCAD locations. Our services are free of charge and can be found in the Blackboard Assist portal at https://scad.blackboard.com/ultra/integration/bbAssist.

University Policies

Academic Integrity

SCAD students are expected to uphold the highest standards of honesty and ethical conduct in all academic endeavors. This commitment to integrity not only ensures the authenticity and value of a SCAD education but also cultivates a culture of trust, respect, and innovation that is crucial in creative industries.

Under all circumstances, students must be honest in their dealings with faculty, administrative staff, and fellow students, and they must submit work that accurately reflects their level of accomplishment. Thus, students shall not engage in an activity that undermines academic integrity or facilitates academic dishonesty by others. This includes, but is not limited to, the following behaviors:

1. Cheating: Using unauthorized assistance, materials, or technology in any academic work.
2. Plagiarism: Using someone else's work, ideas, or words without proper attribution.
3. Fabrication: Falsifying data, information, or citations in academic work.
4. Multiple Submission: Submitting the same work for multiple courses without prior written approval.
5. Facilitation: Helping others commit academic dishonesty or failing to report known academic integrity violations.

If a faculty member suspects a student of academic dishonesty, the faculty member notifies the student of this concern. Once this notification has occurred, the student is prohibited from seeking to withdraw from the course pending the result of a possible investigation. If academic dishonesty is suspected, the faculty member must email all evidence and documentation to **academicdishonesty@scad.edu**.

If the allegation warrants investigation, an academic administrator is appointed to investigate the allegation. If the investigator finds that academic dishonesty has occurred, the student is informed in writing that they will receive an F in the course. The student has five business days from the date on the written notice to appeal the decision of the investigator. If no appeal is made, the student is assigned a grade of F in the course and the student forfeits the right to continue to attend the course in which the academic dishonesty occurred. Students wishing to appeal should do so by emailing **academicappeals@scad.edu**. An appeals committee then convenes to review the case. Findings are presented to academic services, who sends the student a final decision in writing within 30 days of the written appeal. A student found to be in violation of the academic integrity policy may not withdraw from the course(s) in question. Additional sanctions may also be imposed, including suspension or dismissal. A second finding of academic dishonesty may result in dismissal from SCAD.

Attendance

Students are expected to actively engage in courses to achieve the required learning outcomes. Absences in excess of 20% of the course (e.g., five absences for a 10-week course that meets twice per week) result in a failing grade, unless the student withdraws from the

course in accordance with the withdrawal policy. Absences due to late registration are included in the overall absences permitted for the course.

On-ground Attendance
For on-ground courses, students are expected to attend all scheduled class sessions. Tardiness, early departure, or other time away from class in excess of 15 minutes per class session is considered an absence for that class session.

SCADnow Online Attendance
For SCADnow courses, students are expected to check the online course site regularly and academically engage in the work of the course. To earn attendance, students must complete a qualifying academic engagement on a minimum of two separate days per unit/week for 10-week courses, or four separate days per unit/week for 5-week courses.

Qualifying academic engagement is defined as participating in live class sessions (e.g., camera is on with the student visibly present, verbal participation, or use of the chat feature); posting to discussion forums or blogs; submitting assignments; completing quizzes or examinations; attending extra help sessions, office hours, or midterm conferences; and/or corresponding with professors regarding course content.

To access the entire attendance policy, please visit SCAD / Compliance and policies / Attendance.

The student's appearance and conduct should be appropriate and should contribute to the academic and professional atmosphere of SCAD. The university reserves the right at its sole discretion to withdraw the privilege of enrollment from any student whose conduct is detrimental to the academic environment or to the well-being of other students, faculty or staff members, or to the university facilities.

Enrollment policies:
Students are responsible for assuring proper enrollment. See the SCAD catalog for information on add/drop, withdrawals, incompletes, and academic standing.

Midterm Conference(s):
Each student enrolled in the course will have a midterm conference scheduled outside of class time with the professor. Students are expected to keep this appointment.

Access and Accommodations:
Access and Accommodations through The Office of Disability Resources: SCAD is committed to providing an accessible and inclusive environment for all students. Students with established academic accommodations under the ADA from the Office of Disability Resources are encouraged to provide their letter of approved accommodations to faculty in classes in which they are enrolled as soon as possible, as only students who provide the letter are eligible

to use their accommodations. Students who have not yet established services through The Office of Disability Resources and have a documented disability may require academic accommodations are encouraged to contact The Office of Disability Resources as soon as possible since timely notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. The Office of Disability Resources staff will evaluate each request with required documentation, recommend reasonable accommodations, and prepare a letter of approved accommodations for students to provide to faculty dated in the current quarter in which the request is being made. Students are required to renew their accommodations each quarter through the SCAD Accommodate portal to receive their updated accommodations. Students may contact The Office of Disability Resources at disability@scad.edu or 912-525-6233.

Course Evaluations:
Course evaluations offer students a dedicated opportunity to provide constructive feedback on each of their courses. Student feedback gathered through course evaluations is essential to continuously improving the SCAD academic experience. Evaluations are available to students each quarter during Weeks 8, 9, and 10 through MySCAD. For additional information, contact evaluations@scad.edu.

Student Surveys:
SCAD strongly encourages students to provide feedback on their university experience through institutional surveys. The SCAD Student Survey and the Ruffalo Noel Levitz Student Satisfaction Inventory are administered to students across locations each spring. The National Survey of Student Engagement is administered biennially in winter. Following survey administration, SCAD's institutional effectiveness department analyzes and reports results to various SCAD departments to inform data-driven enhancements. For additional information, contact surveys@scad.edu.